

Runner Says Sorry for Riding a Bike in the Berlin Marathon

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A **marathon** is a race of about 26.2 miles. Runners must run the whole way. But at the Berlin **Marathon** on Sept. 27, one runner seems to have taken a ride instead.

Photos appeared to show a Chinese fitness **influencer** riding on the back of a bike during the race. She goes by Abeeeeer on the app Rednote, where she has 520,000 **followers**. An Instagram account that checks race results first shared the photos.

On Saturday, she posted a "sincere **apology**." She said she felt unwell, but that was not an excuse. "My behaviour to take a shortcut was disrespectful to the spirit of the **marathon**," she wrote.

The shoe company Brooks said Brooks China ended its work with her. "Brooks believes running should be grounded in **integrity**, fairness, and respect for competition," the company said.

More than 56,000 runners from 162 countries entered the race.

Word Treasure

marathon -- A very long running race of about 26.2 miles.

influencer -- A person with many followers online who can change what people think or buy.

followers -- People who choose to see someone's posts on social media.

apology -- Words that say you are sorry for something you did.

integrity -- Being honest and doing the right thing.

Background you need

In a marathon, every runner must run the whole course on their own feet.

Races track runners' times along the way, which helps people notice when something looks wrong.

Companies called sponsors support some athletes, and they can stop if the athlete breaks the rules.

Break it down

WHO: A Chinese fitness influencer known as Abeeeeer

WHAT: She said sorry after photos showed her riding a bike during the race

WHERE: The Berlin Marathon

WHY: Riding instead of running breaks the rules and is unfair to other runners

Why it matters

Playing fair matters in every race and game, even when you are tired.

Test what you remember

1. How long is a marathon?

- ☐ (A) About 1 mile
- ☐ (B) About 26.2 miles
- ☐ (C) About 2.6 miles
- ☐ (D) About 262 miles

2. When was the Berlin Marathon?

- ☐ (A) Jan. 1
- ☐ (B) July 4
- ☐ (C) Oct. 7
- ☐ (D) Sept. 27

3. What did photos appear to show?

- ☐ (A) The runner sleeping
- ☐ (B) The runner riding on the back of a bike
- ☐ (C) The runner swimming
- ☐ (D) The runner winning

4. How many followers does she have on Rednote?

- ☐ (A) 520,000
- ☐ (B) 5 million
- ☐ (C) 5,200
- ☐ (D) 520

5. What did the shoe company Brooks do?

- ☐ (A) Brooks China ended its work with her
- ☐ (B) Started the race
- ☐ (C) Made her a champion
- ☐ (D) Gave her new shoes

6. How many runners entered the race?

- ☐ (A) About 5 million
- ☐ (B) About 500
- ☐ (C) Exactly 162
- ☐ (D) More than 56,000

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: B 2: D 3: B 4: A 5: A 6: D

Questions to think about

1. The influencer: Says she felt unwell but that taking a shortcut was disrespectful.
2. Brooks: Says running should be about integrity, fairness and respect.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):